



Standing Committee on National Health Services, Regulations and Coordination (NHSR&C) meets

Islamabad, the 16th April, 2026: The Standing Committee on National Health Services, Regulations and Coordination (NHSR&C) met under the Chairmanship of Dr. Mahesh Kumar Malani, MNA, to deliberate upon key issues concerning medical education, public health challenges and regulatory reforms.

2. The Committee took up the agenda regarding the Pakistan Medical and Dental Council (PMDC) and the Ministry's revised policy for conducting future MDCAT examinations. It was apprised that MDCAT examinations would be conducted soon after the conclusion of all FSC Boards and Cambridge examinations across the country, in order to avoid delays. The Chairman directed the Ministry and PMDC to finalize and announce the schedule well in advance so that students nationwide could prepare accordingly. The Committee also sought a comprehensive update on vacant seats, seat allocation, and student admissions.



Islamabad 16.04.2026: Chairman Standing Committee on National Health Services, Regulations and Coordination Dr. Mahesh Kumar Malani chairing the committee meeting at Parliament House.

3. The Hon. Minister further informed that approximately 1,100 seats had initially remained vacant despite extended deadlines. However, following detailed deliberations and coordinated efforts by the Ministry, PMDC, and the Committee, nearly 98 percent of seats had been filled, benefiting around 1,000 students. The Committee appreciated the M/o NHSR&C and the PMDC for effectively addressing the issue and ensuring optimal utilization of available seats. The Committee expressed serious concern over reported deaths, including suicide cases, in medical colleges, particularly in Punjab and Mirpur Khas. The Ministry was directed to submit a detailed report on such incidents over the past years and to ensure that thorough inquiries were conducted and corrective measures implemented.

4. The issue of rising HIV cases in Pakistan and Taunsa Tehsil were also highlighted, where 331 cases had been reported. The Committee sought clarification termed the situation alarming and directed that a detailed briefing be presented in the next meeting, including information on global funding allocations and their utilization. The Committee also directed the Ministry to strengthen its inspection mechanisms and to take provincial departments on board before finalizing key policies.

5. Furthermore, the Committee discussed the Pakistan Nursing and Midwifery Council Ordinance, 2025 and recommended that the bill be passed after necessary amendments by the Committee.

6. The meeting was attended by MNAs Ms. Zahra Wadood Fatemi, Ms. Farah Naz Akbar, Dr. Shazia Sobia Aslam Soomro, Dr. Shaista Khan, Dr. Nikhat Shakeel Khan, Ms. Aliya Kamran, Dr. Darshan, Ms. Sabheen Ghoury, Raja Khurram Shahzad Nawaz and Ch. Muhammad Shahbaz Babar (virtually). The Minister for National Health, senior officials from the Ministry of NHSR&C, the PMDC, and the M/o Law and Justice and its attached departments also participated in the meeting.